

Figure 5: Microsoft Robotics Developer's Studio

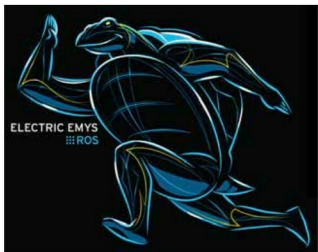


Figure 7: Electric release poster

Let's look at each individual component:

- **plumbing:** ROS provides a publish-subscribe messaging infrastructure designed to support the quick and easy construction of distributed computing systems.
- **tools:** ROS provides an extensive set of tools to configure, start, introspect, debug, visualise, log, test, and stop distributed computing systems.
- **capabilities:** ROS provides a broad collection of libraries that implement useful robot functionality, with a focus on mobility, manipulation and perception.
- **ecosystem:** ROS is supported and improved by a large community, with a strong focus on integration and documentation. www.ros.org is a one-stop-shop for finding out and learning about the thousands of ROS packages that are available from developers around the world.

ROS is not software but an OS

The installation of ROS can be done online, or by downloading the binaries from their website, <http://www.ros.org/wiki/ROS/Installation>. As of now, ROS recommends Ubuntu, while other platforms are being tried



Figure 6: Diamondback release poster



Figure 8: Stage window

and tested.

A fun fact is that every ROS release has a tortoise reference (see Figures 6 and 7):

ROS distribution	Release date
Electric Emys	August 30, 2011
Diamondback	March 2, 2011
C Turtle	August 2, 2011
Box Turtle	March 2, 2010

Table 1: ROS releases

One of the most striking features of ROS is that it works more like an operating system than an application.